4. It should go well with the system of filing in the organization.

5. It should be flexible to allow for expansion when needed.

5.5.3. Advantages of a Good System of Indexing:

A good system of indexing, i.e., which goes well with the filing methods in the organization, offers the following benefits in the field of records management.

1. **Easy Location:** The required papers and documents are located very easily with the help of their index. Referencing is not a painful process.

2. **Easy Cross-Referencing:** A good system of indexing also ensures easy cross-referencing and thus saves on time and botheration.

3. **Lower Costs:** The operating costs of records administration are also low due to improved efficiency of the records administration. Time is not wasted in locating the necessary documents or papers.

5.5.4. Systems or Methods or Types of Indexing

Indexing may be classified into the following main categories, namely: (a) Page Index; (b) Card Index and (c) Visible Index.

(a) **Page or Book Index:** This system is also known as alphabetical indexing as classification is based on the letters of the alphabet. One page or leaf is allotted for each letter of alphabet, fitted with a tab showing the letter and quoting the relevant page numbers. The pages may be held in a loose form or in a bound book form. Each page consists of a list of all the correspondents whose names begin with the letter to which that page or sheet is allotted. For example, all names beginning with the letter 'A' like Anuradha, Anandhi, Akila will be written on the page allocated to the letter 'A'. The folder number of correspondents relating to a particular person will appear against his/her name.

Page Index may take the form of either (1) Bound Book Index (2) Loose Leaf Book Index and (3) Vowel Index. These are described below:

i. **Bound Book Index:** It is in the form of bound book or register which is divide into alphabetical sections where in the names of persons are entered.

   Each section has the leaves cut way at the right hand side so that the initial letters of all the sections are visible at a glance. The book index is very cheap and is a good long time record. The pages cannot be lost or disarranged because they are bound. This is an inflexible method since alterations are difficult and it accommodates a comparatively less number of entries. Example: Telephone Index.

ii. **Loose leaf Book Index (or) Vertical Card Index:** Loose sheets are used for indexing and the fastened are metal rings or hinges or some other device which allows the pages to be taken out and also helps in insertion of additional pages. This type of index is also fitted with a lock. It is very much used by the commercial banks and the joint stock companies for keeping the records

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